



COMPARISON • FRAMEWORKS

CLEAR and the OECD's LOGIC

The OECD's 2024 LOGIC principles tell governments how to make behavioural science a standard part of policymaking. CLEAR tells a team how to run a change. This paper compares the two and shows where each needs the other.

IN BRIEF

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In May 2024 the OECD published LOGIC: Good Practice Principles for Mainstreaming Behavioural Public Policy, a set of fourteen principles across five dimensions (Leadership, Objectives, Governance, Integration, Capability) for embedding behavioural science in government. It complements the OECD's earlier BASIC toolkit, which describes the steps of a single behavioural project. CLEAR is a five-step, iterative method for running organisational change (Clarify, Leverage, Experiment, Analyse, Refine). The frameworks operate at different altitudes: LOGIC is about institutional readiness, BASIC and CLEAR are about doing the work. The comparison shows CLEAR maps closely onto BASIC's project cycle while adding systems mapping and an explicit focus on organisational rather than citizen behaviour, and that LOGIC describes the conditions any organisation needs before CLEAR can be run repeatedly rather than once.

1. Three frameworks, two altitudes

It is easy to compare frameworks as if they were rivals for the same job. The OECD's two behavioural frameworks and CLEAR are not. They answer different questions.

	OECD LOGIC (2024)	OECD BASIC (2019)	CLEAR
Question answered	How does an institution make behavioural science a normal part of how it works?	How do you run one behavioural policy project from problem to scaled result?	How do you run an organisational change so that it actually sticks?
Unit of analysis	A government or public organisation	A policy problem and a target citizen behaviour	An organisational system and the behaviours within it
Structure	5 dimensions, 14 good-practice principles, maturity journeys	5 sequential stages with a toolkit for each	5 iterative steps, repeated in cycles
Primary users	Senior leaders, central units, heads of behavioural teams	Policy analysts, behavioural insight teams	Change leaders, consultants, product and operations teams
Where it was developed	Co-designed in 2023 with 35 government behavioural experts from 14 OECD countries	OECD with behavioural units and academics	Practice-based, from consulting and clinical psychology

LOGIC sits at institutional altitude. BASIC and CLEAR sit at project altitude. The interesting comparison is therefore twofold: CLEAR against BASIC as methods, and CLEAR against LOGIC as method against preconditions.

2. What LOGIC says

LOGIC's premise is that behavioural science has proven itself in pilots and now needs to be mainstreamed, meaning routinely and systematically applied rather than deployed by a specialist unit when someone thinks to ask. Its five dimensions describe what has to be true of an institution for that to happen.

- **Leadership.** Senior leaders explicitly request and advocate for behavioural evidence, and managers actively cultivate that support. Without sponsorship at the top, behavioural work stays a curiosity.
- **Objectives.** Behavioural science is written into strategic plans, with a formal account of how a behavioural perspective helps the organisation reach its goals, and its use is monitored over time.
- **Governance.** There are structures, mandates and ethical safeguards that decide who can apply behavioural methods, how quality is assured, and how the public interest is protected.
- **Integration.** Behavioural thinking is built into standard processes: policy design, regulatory impact assessment, service design, evaluation. It is a step in the workflow, not a parallel track.
- **Capability.** Staff across the organisation, not only specialists, have the skills, tools and networks to apply behavioural science at the level their role requires.

The framework is deliberately not a method. It does not tell you how to diagnose a behaviour or design an intervention. It assumes you have BASIC or an equivalent for that, and asks what surrounds it.

3. CLEAR against BASIC: the method comparison

BASIC's five stages are Behaviour (identify and prioritise the target behaviour), Analysis (diagnose why it happens, using the ABCD lens of attention, belief formation, choice and determination), Strategies (design interventions), Intervention (test them, ideally experimentally), and Change (scale, monitor, maintain). CLEAR's are Clarify (objectives and key results), Leverage (map the system and find intervention points), Experiment (test small), Analyse (evaluate against key results, attend to surprises), Refine (feed learning back, scale, start the next cycle).

BASIC	CLEAR	Difference in emphasis
© 2026 Erik Bohjort Behaviour	clear-framework.com Clarify	CLEAR and the OECD's LOGIC BASIC starts from a target behaviour. CLEAR starts from an outcome and measurable key results, and only then decides which behaviours, if any, need to change. This allows outcomes to be reached without behaviour change where the system permits it.
Analysis	Leverage	BASIC diagnoses the individual's decision process (ABCD). CLEAR maps the organisational system: feedback loops, dependencies, incentives and structures, and looks for points where small changes propagate. Individual psychology is one input, not the frame.
Strategies + Intervention	Experiment	Both insist on testing. CLEAR pushes towards many small, cheap prototypes at leverage points, in the spirit of design thinking, rather than one well-powered trial.
Change	Analyse + Refine	BASIC treats scaling as the end of the cycle. CLEAR treats it as the start of the next one and gives explicit weight to surprises and failures as the most valuable data.

The two are close relatives. The genuine differences are three. First, the starting point: behaviour versus outcome. Second, the unit of diagnosis: the individual mind versus the organisational system. Third, the shape: BASIC is a sequence that can be repeated, CLEAR is a loop by design, with each cycle expected to sharpen the objectives set in the last.

4. CLEAR against LOGIC: method meets preconditions

Read LOGIC as a checklist of what an organisation needs before a project method can be run more than once, and the comparison with CLEAR becomes practical.

Where CLEAR already covers LOGIC's ground

The Clarify step does at project level what LOGIC's Objectives dimension asks at institutional level: it forces an explicit statement of what success means and how it will be measured. A CLEAR programme that has been run well produces exactly the evidence base LOGIC's Leadership dimension wants senior leaders to be asking for. And the Refine step, by feeding learning back into the next cycle, is a small-scale version of LOGIC's Integration principle: the behavioural perspective becomes part of how the next piece of work is planned.

Where LOGIC identifies what CLEAR cannot do alone

CLEAR is silent on governance. It assumes the team running it has the mandate, ethical framework and quality assurance to do so. In a corporate setting that assumption is often safe; in a public one it is not, and LOGIC's Governance dimension is a necessary addition. CLEAR is also silent on capability beyond the team in the room. LOGIC's Capability dimension makes the point that a method is only

mainstream when people outside the specialist unit can apply it. A CLEAR practice that lives with one consultant or one internal team has not been mainstreamed, however good its results.

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Where CLEAR sharpens LOGIC

LOGIC's Objectives dimension asks organisations to state how behavioural science serves strategy. It does not, because it is not a method, say how to size those objectives. CLEAR's insistence on key results, and the practitioner discipline of matching goal size to intervention size, gives LOGIC's Objectives principle teeth. And LOGIC's Integration dimension talks about embedding behavioural thinking in processes; CLEAR's Leverage step supplies the systems map that shows which processes matter.

THE COMBINED PICTURE

LOGIC tells an institution what has to be true for behavioural work to be routine. BASIC or CLEAR tells a team how to do the work. CLEAR's distinctive contribution is to treat the organisation itself as the system under intervention, which is precisely the system LOGIC is trying to change.

5. Practical guidance

If you are in government or a regulated public body: use LOGIC to assess institutional maturity across the five dimensions before committing to any project method. Then run projects with BASIC where the target is a citizen behaviour and the diagnostic tradition (ABCD) fits, and with CLEAR where the target is the organisation's own behaviour: how a department adopts a new process, how a service team changes its working pattern, how a policy unit learns from its own experiments.

If you are in a company: LOGIC's dimensions translate directly. Does leadership ask for behavioural evidence? Is behavioural change written into strategy with measurable objectives? Who is allowed to run experiments on staff and customers, under what ethical rules? Is behavioural thinking part of product, HR and operations processes, or a separate innovation team? Can people outside that team do the work? Score yourselves, then run CLEAR cycles on the dimensions that scored lowest. The organisation's own adoption of behavioural science is a change problem, and CLEAR is built for change problems.

If you are a practitioner choosing a method: the choice between BASIC and CLEAR is mostly a choice of starting point and unit of analysis. Start from a behaviour and a citizen, use BASIC. Start from an outcome and a system, use CLEAR. Either way, LOGIC is the list of things that will stop your second project from happening even if your first one succeeds.

6. Conclusion

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The OECD's LOGIC framework is an important document because it names the real bottleneck in behavioural public policy: not the lack of methods, but the lack of institutions ready to use them routinely. CLEAR does not compete with it. CLEAR is one of the methods LOGIC assumes, closest in shape to the OECD's own BASIC, and differing from it by starting with outcomes rather than behaviours, by mapping systems rather than individual decisions, and by looping rather than sequencing. Where the two meet is the organisation itself: LOGIC describes the destination, and CLEAR is a method for getting an organisation there one experiment at a time.

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